UNIT 38.2 · LEVEL C1

Cleft sentences – wh-clefts (pseudo-clefts)

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 Which sentence is a wh-cleft?

a) It was a holiday that I needed. **b)** I need a holiday badly.
c) What I need is a holiday. **d)** A holiday was needed by me.

2 _____ annoys me most is his constant lateness.

a) What **b)** That **c)** Who **d)** It

3 What she did _____ call the police.

a) were **b)** has **c)** being **d)** was

4 What we need _____ more time.

a) are **b)** is **c)** do **d)** have

5 What I really want to do _____ travel the world.

a) does **b)** is **c)** has **d)** are

6 What he did was _____ the door.

a) slammed **b)** slamming **c)** slams **d)** slam

7 Which sentence is a reversed wh-cleft?

a) A good rest is what I need. **b)** What I need is a good rest.
c) It is a good rest I need. **d)** I need a good rest.

8 All _____ I want is a quiet evening.

a) what **b)** which **c)** that **d)** who

9 What happened _____ that the engine suddenly stopped.

a) were **b)** been **c)** being **d)** was

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10 What does a wh-cleft do?

a) It highlights the information that follows be

b) It makes the sentence negative

c) It changes the sentence to the past

d) It removes the subject

Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 _____ I enjoy most is walking by the sea.

12 What she bought _____ a second-hand bike.

13 All I did _____ ask a simple question.

14 What I'm looking for _____ a quiet place to work.

15 A real friend is _____ everybody needs.

16 What happened next _____ a complete surprise.

17 _____ you should do is call her right now.

18 The thing _____ bothers me is the noise.

19 What he wants to do _____ start his own business.

20 Where we stayed _____ a lovely old farmhouse.

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **what / I / is / need / a / break**

_____

22 **did / what / was / she / leave / early**

_____

23 **is / I / what / want / the / truth**

_____

24 **all / he / did / was / say / hello**

_____

25 **what / worries / is / me / the / cost**

_____

26 **a / is / holiday / need / what / I**

_____

27 **what / next / happened / surprising / was / very**

_____

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28 **what / you / is / should / do / apologise**

_____

Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the opening word.*
_____ I need most is a good night's sleep.
Options: **What** / **That** / **Who**

30 *Choose the linking verb.*
What she wanted _____ to be left alone.
Options: **was** / **were** / **been**

31 *Choose the verb form.*
What we did was _____ the whole house.
Options: **paint** / **painted** / **painting**

32 *Choose the right word.*
All _____ I want is a hot shower.
Options: **that** / **what** / **who**

33 *Choose the verb.*
What really bothers me _____ that he never listens.
Options: **is** / **are** / **does**

34 *Choose the reversed form.*
A cup of coffee _____ I need right now.
Options: **is what** / **what is** / **that is**

35 *Choose the question word.*
_____ we spent the summer was a tiny island.
Options: **Where** / **What** / **Who**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each beginning to its ending.

1. What I need is _____
2. All she did was _____
3. What happened next was _____
4. What worries me is _____

A. leave without a word.
B. the lack of time.
C. a long holiday.
D. completely unexpected.

37 Match each normal sentence to its wh-cleft.

1. I need a coffee. _____
2. She lost her keys. _____
3. He wants some peace. _____
4. They enjoyed the music. _____

A. What they enjoyed was the music.
B. What I need is a coffee.
C. What she lost was her keys.
D. What he wants is some peace.

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38 Match each beginning to its ending.

1. Where we met was _____
2. When we arrived was _____
3. The reason I called was _____
4. The person I admire most is _____

A. my grandmother.
B. to ask for help.
C. just after sunset.
D. a crowded café.

39 Match each sentence to the part it emphasises.

1. What I broke was my phone. _____
2. What she did was apologise. _____
3. Where we stayed was Lisbon. _____
4. When he left was midnight. _____

A. The action
B. The place
C. The time
D. The object

40 Match each incorrect sentence to its correction.

1. That I want is peace. _____
2. What he did were shout. _____
3. All what I want is sleep. _____
4. What worries me are the cost. _____

A. All I want is sleep.
B. What I want is peace.
C. What worries me is the cost.
D. What he did was shout.

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 What I need are a long rest. Correct word: _____

42 All which I want is some peace. Correct word: _____

43 What she did were call the police. Correct word: _____

44 Who I want is a cup of tea. Correct word: _____

45 What we did was to went home early. Correct word: _____

46 What he want to do is move abroad. Correct word: _____

47 The thing what annoys me is the traffic. Correct word: _____

48 What we need most is more times. Correct word: _____

49 A good book is that I want. Correct word: _____

50 Where I grew up are a small town. Correct word: _____

Your score

Count one point for each correct answer. Below 70%? Review the topic and try the unit again in a few days.

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

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Answer Key

Cleft sentences – wh-clefts (pseudo-clefts)

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** What I need is a holiday.	A wh-cleft = What + clause + be + focus.
2	**a)** What	Start a wh-cleft with What.
3	**d)** was	Use was after What she did.
4	**b)** is	Time is singular, so is.
5	**b)** is	Use is after What I want to do.
6	**d)** slam	After What he did was, use the base verb.
7	**a)** A good rest is what I need.	The wh-clause can come at the end.
8	**c)** that	After All, use that (or nothing).
9	**d)** was	Use was for a past event.
10	**a)** It highlights the information that follows be	The focus comes after be.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**What**	Start with What.
12	**was**	Past event: was.
13	**was**	All I did was + base verb.
14	**is**	Use is for a present need.
15	**what**	Reversed wh-cleft: ... is what ...
16	**was**	Past event: was.
17	**What**	Start with What.
18	**that** (or: which)	The thing that ... is ...
19	**is**	Use is for a present wish.
20	**was**	Past place: was.

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**What I need is a break.**	What + clause + is + focus.
22	**What she did was leave early.**	Use the base verb after was.
23	**What I want is the truth.**	Focus on the truth.
24	**All he did was say hello.**	All + clause + was + base verb.
25	**What worries me is the cost.**	Focus on the cost.
26	**A holiday is what I need.**	Reversed wh-cleft.
27	**What happened next was very surprising.**	Focus on the result.

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28	**What you should do is apologise.**	Advice with a wh-cleft.

Part D · Choose and Complete

29	**What**	Start with What.
30	**was**	Use was in the past.
31	**paint**	Use the base verb after was.
32	**that**	After All, use that.
33	**is**	Use is after the wh-clause.
34	**is what**	Reversed: focus + is what + clause.
35	**Where**	Where refers to a place.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B**	What I need is – a long holiday.; All she did was – leave without a word.; What happened next was – completely unexpected.; What worries me is – the lack of time. The focus comes after is / was.
37	**1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A**	I need a coffee. – What I need is a coffee.; She lost her keys. – What she lost was her keys.; He wants some peace. – What he wants is some peace.; They enjoyed the music. – What they enjoyed was the music. Turn the object into the focus.
38	**1-D 2-C 3-B 4-A**	Where we met was – a crowded café.; When we arrived was – just after sunset.; The reason I called was – to ask for help.; The person I admire most is – my grandmother. Choose the natural ending.
39	**1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C**	What I broke was my phone. – The object; What she did was apologise. – The action; Where we stayed was Lisbon. – The place; When he left was midnight. – The time The focus follows be.
40	**1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C**	That I want is peace. – What I want is peace.; What he did were shout. – What he did was shout.; All what I want is sleep. – All I want is sleep.; What worries me are the cost. – What worries me is the cost. Fix the opening word or the verb.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**is**	The verb agrees with a long rest.
42	**that**	After All, use that.
43	**was**	Use was after What she did.
44	**What**	Use What for things.
45	**go** (or: to go)	Use the base verb: to go / go.
46	**wants**	He wants: third person -s.
47	**that** (or: which)	Use that, not what.
48	**time**	Time is uncountable here.
49	**what**	Reversed wh-cleft needs what.
50	**is** (or: was)	A small town is singular.

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